

LILY TAN

West Lafayette, IN 47906

(765) 532-3430 | tyaling@purdue.edu | [LinkedIn](#) | [Portfolio](#)

EDUCATION

PURDUE UNIVERSITY

West Lafayette, IN, U.S.

- Doctor of Philosophy in Learning Design and Technology
- Advisor: Dr. Victoria Lynn Lowell

Started 2025

NORTHEASTERN UNIVERSITY

Shenyang, CHINA

- Master of Arts in Interpreting
- Advisor: Dr. Lulu Gao

2024

UNIVERSITY OF SILESIA (DOUBLE-DEGREE PROGRAM)

Katowice, POLAND

- Master of Philology
- Advisor: Dr. Adam Wojtaszek

2024

SOUTHWEST UNIVERSITY OF SCIENCE AND TECHNOLOGY

Mianyang, CHINA

- Bachelor of Arts in Translation

2022

RESEARCH INTERESTS

I study how emerging technologies extend learning beyond the classroom. My work spans informal digital learning, human-centered AI, and human-computer interaction, with a focus on designing AI-supported learning experiences that are authentic, learner-driven, and grounded in real-world use.

- Informal Digital Learning
- Human-center AI
- Human-computer interaction

PUBLICATIONS

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Peer-Reviewed Journal Publications

- Li, B., ***Tan, L.**, Zakharov, W., Qiu, Q., & Acton, C. (in press, 2026). From answer bot to course tutor: A practical design case of a guardrailed AI assistant in higher education. Invited book chapter, Springer.
- Li, B., ***Tan, L.**, Zakharov, W., Acton, C. B., & Qiu, Q. (2026). Tutor,Not Solver: Designing a Guardrailed AI Assistant for Learning in Higher Education: A Design Case of PeteChat. arXiv preprint arXiv:2606.09845.
- Wang, S. & ***Tan, L.** (2026). Doubao as a GenAI scaffold in senior high school EFL writing: A practice-oriented framework for improving writing performance. *Psicologia Educativa*. 14, 19-33. <https://doi.org/10.22201/fpsic.24486957e.2026.14.181> (Q2).
- Li, B., ***Tan, L.Y.**, Wang, C., & Lowell, V. (2025). Two years of innovation: A systematic review of empirical generative AI research in language learning and teaching. *Computers and Education: Artificial Intelligence*, 9, 100445. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.caeai.2025.100445> (Q1, IF ≈ 10.5).
- ***Tan, L.Y.**, & Gao, L. (2025). Pointing to context from a relevance theory perspective: A comparative study of human and machine interpreting. *Mediterranean Journal of Social Sciences*, 16(3), 1. <https://doi.org/10.36941/mjss-2025-0023>
- Gao, L., & ***Tan, Y.** (2023). Study on master of translation and interpreting talent cultivation mode from the perspective of CLIL. *Education Advances*, 13(12), 10029-10034. <https://doi.org/10.12677/AE.2023.13121549>

Under Review

- ***Tan, L.**, Wang, C., Li, B., Lowell, V., & Xiao, F. (Under Review). Comparison matters: A three-level meta-analysis of the effects of digital technology on educationally underserved learners. *Educational Research Review*.
- Liu, H. & ***Tan, L.** (Under Review). Pre-service teachers' TPACK in Xinjiang: examining culture diversity as context. *The Asia-Pacific Education Researcher*.

- Li, B. & *Tan, L. (Under Review). Authorship, agency, and AI: how higher education instructors navigate authenticity in student writing. *Education Science*.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

MODERN META ANALYSIS RESEARCH INSTITUTE (MMARI) (Jul 2026) Chicago, IL, U.S.
NSF-funded Research Training Participant

- Completed intensive training on systematic review and meta-analysis methods aligned with Campbell Collaboration and MECCIR reporting standards.
- Critiqued published reviews against methodological quality criteria in a collaborative team setting.
- Applied meta-analytic reasoning to evaluate evidence synthesis in education research.

PURDUE UNIVERSITY (Sep 2025 – May 2026) West Lafayette, IN, U.S.
Research Assistant, Purdue Library and School of Information Studies

- Participating in three research projects, including a scoping review, a study on AI-assisted learning in students' research projects, and an investigation of audio and video effects in librarians' teaching.
- Screened, coded, and synthesized data for a scoping review encompassing over 20,000 articles.
- Conducted literature searches and provided statistical analysis support for selected research projects.

HONEYBEE TECHNOLOGY CO., LTD (Jan - Jul 2025) Chengdu, CHINA
Career Planning Specialist

- Assessed over 300+ students' academic backgrounds and aspirations to create tailored education roadmaps.
- Revised and edited over 100 résumés/CVs; coached students on interview strategies for job placement and graduate school admissions, resulting in a 100% success rate in achieving their desired positions or schools.
- Collaborated with colleagues to design a comprehensive Standard Operating Procedure (SOP) that reduced onboarding time and enhanced team efficiency.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

My teaching philosophy is grounded in the belief that language acquisition is most effective when it is data-informed, authentic, and technologically empowered. Drawing on my research in Informal Digital Learning of English (IDLE) and AI-assisted self-directed learning, I aim to transition students from passive recipients of knowledge to active, autonomous learners who can navigate real-world linguistic challenges.

PURDUE UNIVERSITY (Aug 2026 - Present) West Lafayette, IN, U.S.
Graduate Teaching Assistant, John Martinson Honors College
HONR 19901: Honors First Year Experience I (Forge Your Story)

- Serve as a Graduate Learning Assistant for the Honors College first-year seminar, supporting instruction and student engagement in a 20-hour-per-week appointment.
- Lead the Assessment and Course Improvement workstream, collecting and analyzing student feedback and learning data to inform revisions to course design and delivery.

PURDUE UNIVERSITY (Feb 25th, 2026) West Lafayette, IN, U.S.
Guest Lecturer, EDCI 612: AI and Multilingual Learners

- Co-presented with Dr. Victoria Lowell and Belle Li on GenAI research and language education, covering learning analytics, AI tutors, and instructional design implications for multilingual learners.

UNIVERSITY OF SILESIA (Oct 2023 - Jun 2024) Katowice, POLAND
Lecturer at the Institute of Linguistics

- Developed and delivered targeted lessons on Spoken Chinese and Academic Writing at the Institute of Linguistics. Designed weekly online and in-person oral Chinese tests to track students' learning and graded their assignments to offer scaffolding through emails.
- Instructed 200+ Chinese learners from diverse international backgrounds, enhancing their academic communication and presentation skills in oral formats.
- Reported monthly and semester reports on students' performance using SPSS and Prism.

NORTHEASTERN UNIVERSITY (Feb 2023 - Jul 2023) Shenyang, CHINA
Teaching Assistant

- Instructed 100+ undergraduates in oral interpreting techniques, with a focus on pronunciation, coherence, and public speaking in real-world contexts
- Collected and analyzed student performance data using SPSS to track progress through reports and provide personalized, data-informed feedback.
- Rated weekly, monthly, and semester-long interpreting tests using Audacity for detailed speech analysis and scoring.

TAL EDUCATION GROUP (Feb 2021 - Jan 2022)

Chengdu, CHINA

Lecturer in English Department

- Taught spoken English and presentation strategies to 500+ elementary and high school student, focusing on fluency, pronunciation, and confidence-building in public speaking.
- Conducted informal assessments of students' speaking abilities and provided personalized feedback to foster measurable oral improvement.
- Organized English speech contests and coached students, leading to multiple regional and school-level awards, including the national FLTRP·ETIC Cup Understanding Contemporary China' International Communication Contest.

ACADEMIC PRESENTATIONS

*Denotes upcoming presentation

- ***Tan, L.**, Lowell, V., Li, B., & Fei, X. (2026, October). *Scaffolding extramural GAI-mediated informal digital learning of English for pragmatic competence: An epistemic network analysis*. AECT International Convention, Chicago, IL.
- ***Li, B., Tan, L.**, Zakharov, W., Qiu, Q., & Acton, C. (2026, October). *A design case of PeteChat: Designing AI tutors that teach students how to think, not what to answer*. AECT International Convention, Chicago, IL.
- **Tan, L.** (2026, February 18). *Clawdbot Unboxed: What It Does, Why It's Hot, and Where It Breaks*. AI Lunch and Learn Series, College of Education, Purdue University, West Lafayette, IN.
- **Tan, L.**, Lowell, V. & Li, B. (2025, November 10th). *Assessing the Effects of Extramural GAI-mediated Informal Digital Learning of English on Pragmatic and Communicative Competence of Chinese Undergraduates: A Mixed-methods Study*. Purdue AI in P-12 Conference, West Lafayette, IN.
- Li, B., Wang, J., & **Tan, L.** (2025, October 12th). *Artificial authenticity and academic integrity in an age of generative AI: Exploring higher education instructors' perspectives*. AECT International Convention, Las Vegas, NV.
- **Tan, L.** (2024, September 29th). *Pointing to Context from a Relevance Theory Perspective: A Comparative Study of Human and Machine Interpreting*. XXIIInd International Computer Assisted Language Learning, Tokyo, Japan.
- **Tan, L.** & Zhang, Y. (2024, May 17th to 19th). *Exploring the Extracurricular Development of AI-Assisted English Learners: A Phenomenological Exploration*. The 3rd International Conference on Sociocultural Theory and Foreign Language Research, Guangdong, China
- **Tan, L.** (2024, May 30th to June 1st). The 10th International Conference on Intercultural Pragmatics and Communication. Pisa, Italy.

SERVICE AND LEADERSHIP

My service philosophy is to strengthen academic communities through reliable and design-minded support. I focus on making opportunities visible, communication clear, and events smooth, so others can participate with

less friction. I also prioritize inclusive mentoring by connecting people thoughtfully and fostering supportive and sustainable relationships. I serve consistently, listen first, and improve systems based on real needs.

Journal Peer Review

- Ad-hoc Reviewer, ACM Transactions on Computing Education (TOCE), 2026
- Proposal Reviewer, AECT International Convention, 2026
- Graduate Judge, Purdue AI in P-12 Conference, 2025

PALDT (Purdue Association of Learning Design and Technology) (Sep 2025 – July 2026)

Marketing & Design Officer

- Weekly manage PALDT's online presence and social media and design promotional materials for events and announcements biweekly. Support technology needs for PALDT functions and meetings.

GESC (Purdue Graduate Student Education Council) (Sep 2025 – July 2026)

Committee Member

- Collaborate with committee members to design and coordinate mentorship initiatives.
- Match mentors and mentees based on research interests, career goals, and program needs to foster meaningful connections.

Purdue Lunar New Year Celebration, Asian American and Asian Resource and Cultural Center (AAARCC) (February 2026)

Cultural Exhibit Contributor

- Represented the College of Education; designed and hosted a cultural exhibit booth for 1,200+ attendees

HONORS, AWARDS, AND RECOGNITIONS

Summer Research Grant (2026)

- Department of Curriculum and Instruction, Purdue University; .50 FTE Graduate Research Assistantship with tuition remission (\$4,695.68), College of Education.

Top 10 Best Practices in AIED, World Digital Education Alliance (WDEA) (2026)

- 2026 Global Call for Best Practices in AIED: Scenarios-Driven Educational Transformation. Awarded for *Tutor, not solver: Designing a guardrailed AI assistant for learning in higher education.*

Seeding Solutions Phase 1 Award, ShahLab. AI (2026)

- Purdue University, VIP AI for Education Team; Graduate Assistant on AI-Powered Personalized Support for Working Adult Online Learners in partnership with Purdue Global (\$2,000).

Data Stewardship Award – Finalist

- Purdue Libraries (NSF-funded initiative), AY 2025-selected for PeteChat: A Guardrailed AI Tutor for Higher Education.

Graduate Student & Travel Awards (2025)

- Curriculum and Instruction and Learning Design & Technology Programs, Purdue University: LDT Travel Support Program (\$250)

National Academic Fellowship (2023-2024)

- Northeastern University, Department of Interpreting (\$2000)

Erasmus+ Fund (2024)

- University of Silesia, Department of Linguistics (\$5000)

National Undergraduate Award (2019)

- Southwest University of Science and Technology, Department of Translation (\$750)

MEMBERSHIP IN PROFESSIONAL AND ACADEMIC SOCIETIES

- American Educational Research Association (AERA) (2025 - Present)
- Association for Educational Communications and Technology (AECT) (2025 - Present)

CERTIFICATIONS

Quality Matters Rubric Workshop (7th ed.) Certificate. (Mar 2026).

REFERENCES

Dr. Victoria Lowell

Associate Professor, Learning Design and Technology

College of Education, Purdue University

vllowell@purdue.edu

Dr. Jerilyn Pia Tinio

Clinical Assistant Professor, Humanities, Social Sciences, and Education Library

Purdue University Libraries

jtinio@purdue.edu